Zoom & Slack Orientation

DATA SCIENCE BOOTCAMP

NASHVILLE SOFTWARE SCHOOL

Zoom Orientation

You will be spending a lot of time on Zoom while in your bootcamp. Zoom and similar tools are also platforms that you will almost certainly continue to use throughout your career. We have put together some tips to:

1. Familiarize you with the most commonly used features
2. Get you in the habit of using professional etiquette when on the platform

If you prefer to watch videos, you can check out Zoom's videos that walk through a variety of features

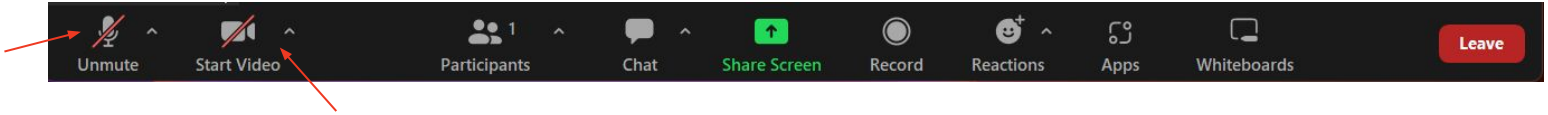
Zoom Professional Etiquette

1. Keep yourself muted unless you are speaking
2. Keep your camera on as a general rule
   - For the purposes of the course, it is OK to briefly turn your camera off if, for example, you are eating a snack or similar
3. Make sure your background and visible surroundings are professional in appearance (e.g. don't be laying in bed or similar)
   - You can make use of background blurring or set a digital background
   - This is mandatory whenever meeting with external stakeholders such as for career development events or partner project introductions and presentations
4. Use of chat, hand raising, and reactions can all be part of professional interaction on the platform

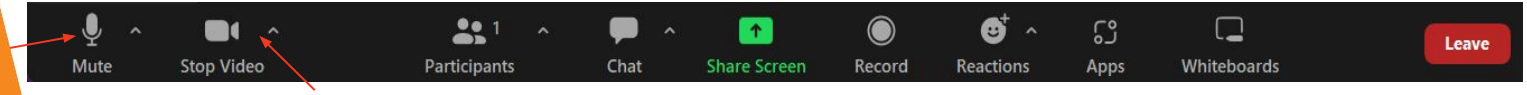
Zoom Features - Audio and Camera Settings

The buttons to mute/unmute and turn your camera off/on are located along the bottom of the Zoom window. Simply click the relevant icon to switch yourself from muted to unmuted or your camera from off to on. For more advanced audio and video settings, click on the carrot next to the relevant icon.

Icon appearances when muted and camera off:

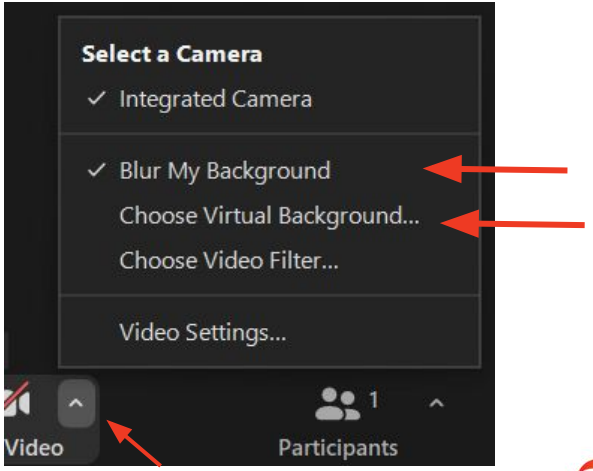


Icon appearances when unmuted and camera on:



Zoom Features - Backgrounds

You may at times be working in a space that has a distracting appearance. You can make use of Zoom's built in features to maintain a professional background appearance. By clicking the carrot next to the video icon, you can blur your background or open the Virtual Background options to choose a digital background.



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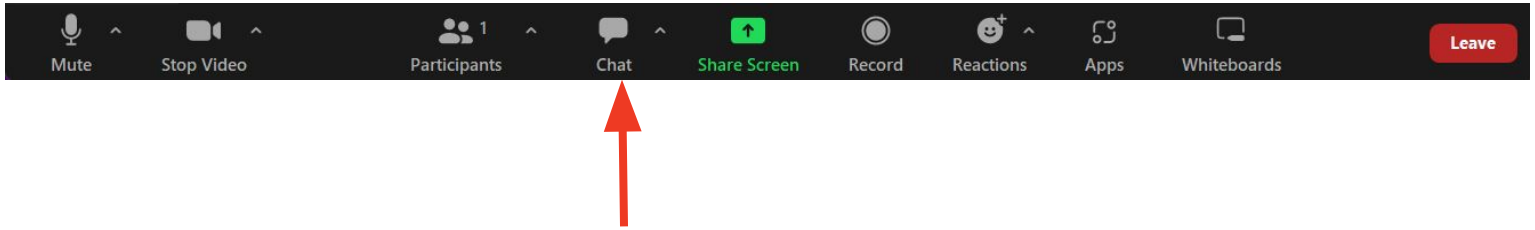
Zoom Features - Chat

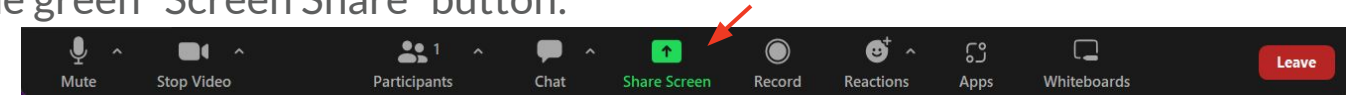
During lectures, additional information/links will often be shared in the session's chat, so keep an eye out for activity here.

This can also be a good place to add your observations and/or questions if you don't want to interrupt the person who is speaking.

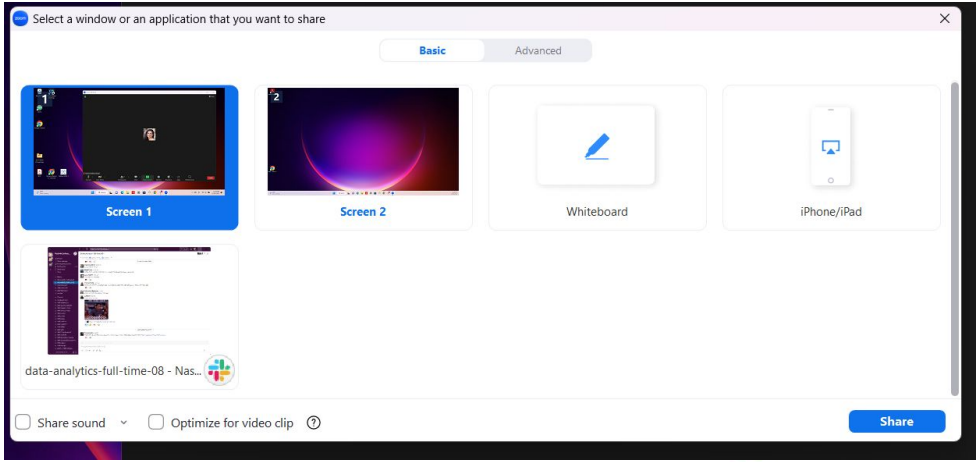


Zoom Features - Share Screen

If you are having difficulty with something, we will often ask you to share your screen so that we can help you troubleshoot. To initiate screen sharing, click on the green “Screen Share” button:

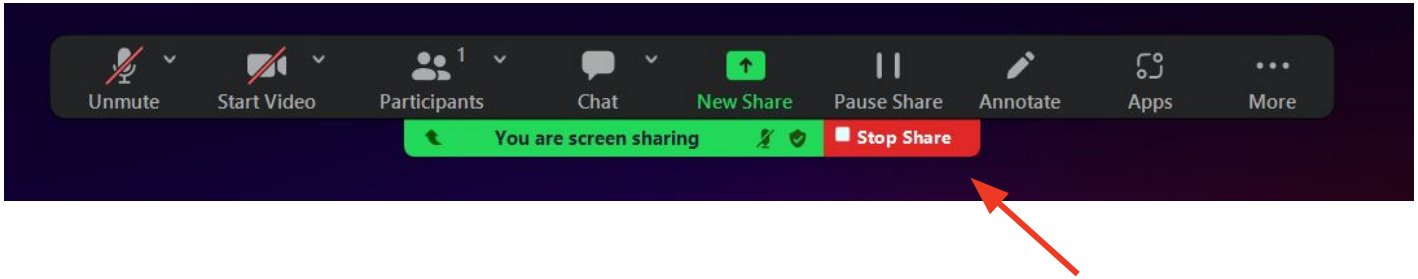


Then select the relevant screen or specific window to share:



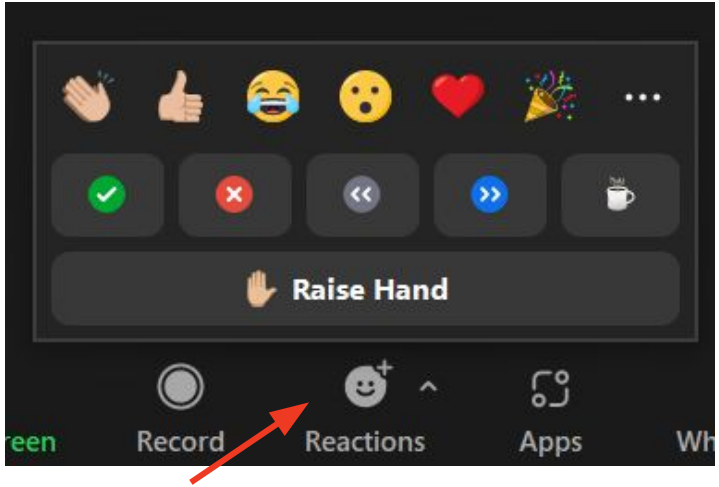
Zoom Features - Screen Share

Once you are sharing your screen, the Zoom controls tend to move to the top of the screen, though if you have multiple screens, they may move to a screen you are NOT sharing. Use the red “Stop Share” button when you are ready to stop sharing your screen.



Zoom Features - Reactions

You can click the “Reactions” button to see available reactions. Options like the green check or “Raise Hand” will remain in place until you or the host remove them. Other reactions like clapping will only remain visible for a short time.



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Zoom Features - Breakout Rooms

We will often use breakout rooms to facilitate individual and group work. When breakout rooms are available, The Breakout Rooms icon will appear in the Zoom controls along the bottom of your screen. Simply click on this icon to select a room to join. You can also click the drop down next to each room to see who is already in a given room.

Slack Orientation

Slack is a primary communication tool we will use throughout the class. It is set up to easily facilitate group and one-on-one messaging. You will maintain access to the NSS Slack workspace even after you graduate, and the company you end up working for may well have their own workspace (or use a similar tool). We have put together some tips to:

1. Help you get to know Slack's structure and features
2. Clarify which types of messages to send in the different channels or as DMs

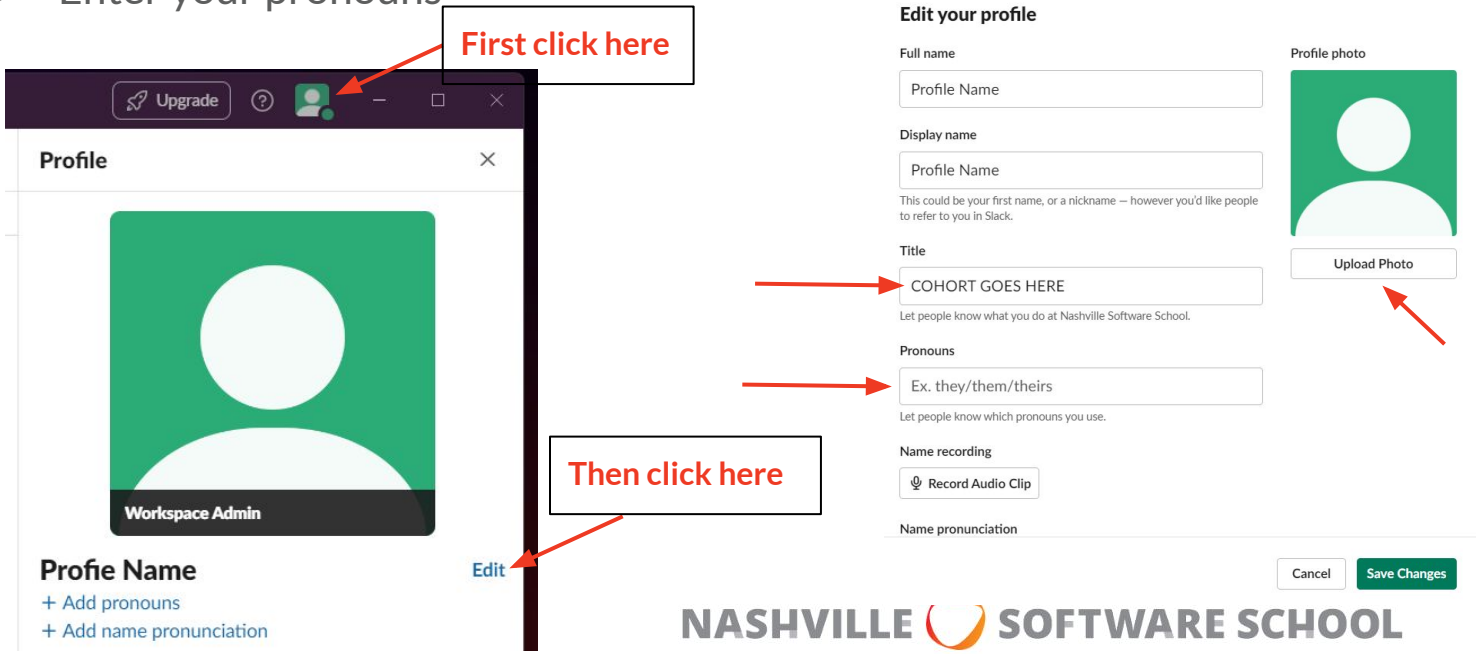
Getting the most out of Slack

1. Be thoughtful about what you send in a channel vs. what is better suited as a DM
   - For example, if something has come up last minute and you're running late for class, message the instructors directly as opposed to posting in the class channel.
2. Become familiar with the different channels and what is shared/asked in each.
   - For example, if you have a question about a class project, post that in the class channel, not the general channel.
3. Make use of the posts that will be pinned in the class channel. Most important info (such as the class Zoom link) can be found here, along the top of the window just under the channel name.
4. NSS uses the free version of Slack, so messages are not retained forever. If there is information (such as useful links) you want to hang on to for more than 90 days, make sure to copy and save it elsewhere.

Slack - Updating Your Profile

On the first day of class make sure to update your profile with the following:

- Upload a picture that clearly shows your face
- Update the “Title” field to note your cohort (DS8)
- Enter your pronouns



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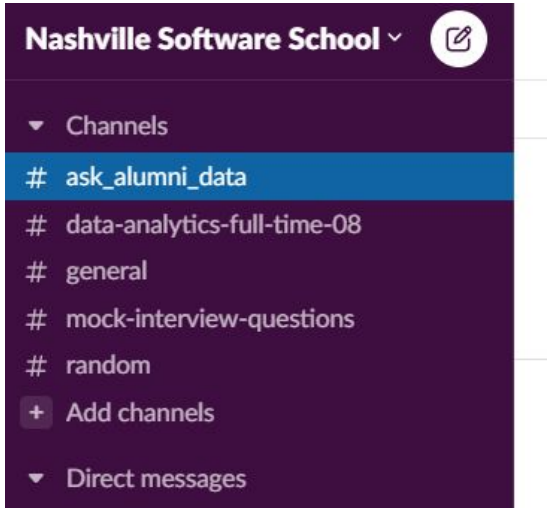
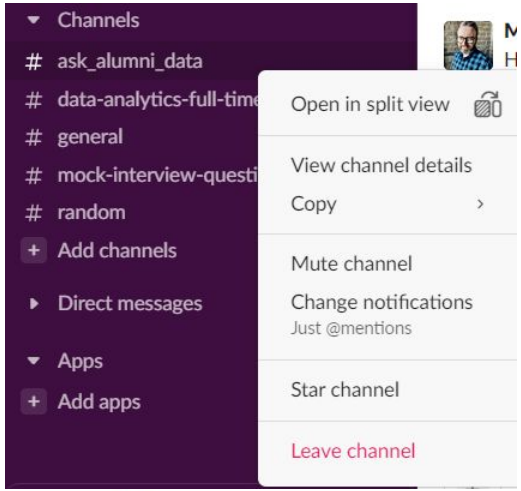
Slack Features - Channels

Slack channels, visible along the left side of the window, make it easy to communicate with set groups. You will automatically be a member of the general and random channels as well as the channel for your specific cohort. You can right click on a specific channel to star it, adjust notification settings, and more.





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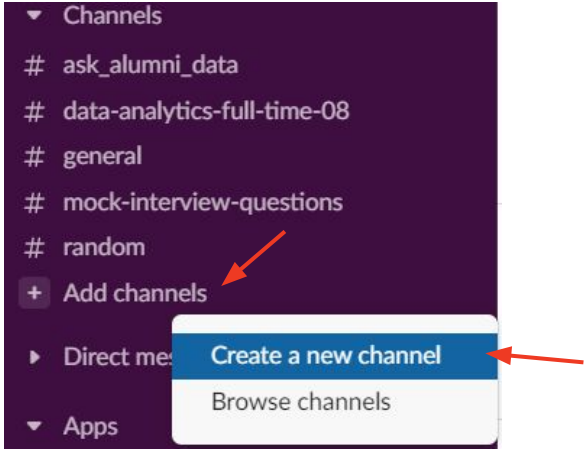
Slack Features - Adding Channels

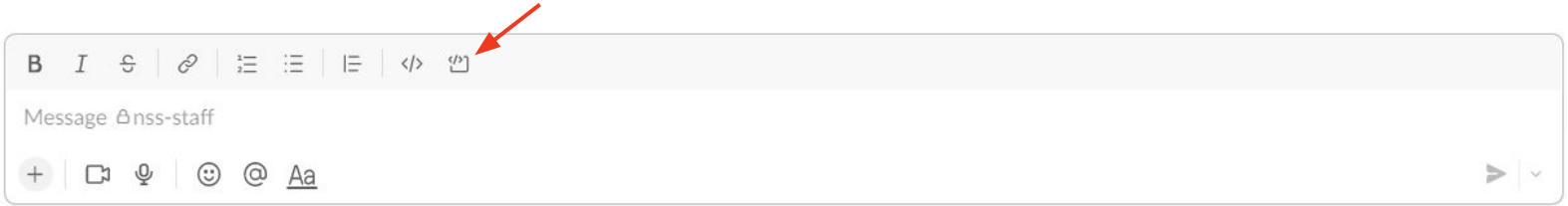
Once you start working on group projects, you will need to create a new channel for your group. To do this, simply click on “Add channels” at the bottom of the Channels section, select “Create a new channel”, then give the channel a name. The beginning of any channel name should be your cohort’s name.

For example:

dda7_best_team_ever

Once created, you can add members to the channel. Always add all of your instructors to the group.



Slack Features - Sending Code in Messages

Slack messaging has a feature that makes sending code in a legible format MUCH easier. Simply click the code block icon in the toolbar (there is also a keyboard shortcut- hover over the icon to see what this is).